

‘It kind of feels like nothing has changed’

As Cornell case stokes women’s rage, it raises questions about #MeToo progress

By Janelle Nanos
GLOBE STAFF

It was the screen grabs that did it.

Over the last week, as news spread about the lawsuit filed by Jane Doe, a former Cornell student who alleges that she was gang raped by seven Chi Phi fraternity brothers in 2024, the tenor of

the reaction on social media can perhaps best be described as white hot fury.

For many women, it was as if seeing the vile messages shared that night — the accused offenders advertised “free” sex on Snapchat, saying “you can walk in and whip it out” — had roused an army of sleeper cell agents into action. This incident, judging by the online out-

rage, was not just another #MeToo moment: It was cause for a flip-the-table, burn-it-all-down primal scream.

► **Federal government quiet on sexual assault cases. A2.**

As the actor Rati Gupta put it: “Maybe instead of Me Too, this round is [Expletive] Off.”

It’s been nearly a decade since the #MeToo hashtag went viral, and “it feels like ‘Groundhog Day,’” said Caitlin Lawson, a professor of

gender and media studies at Emmanuel College. “We’ve already talked about this. We already talked about how institutions fail survivors. We’ve talked about the myth of the perfect victim. We’ve done this before, but we’re here again, and so it kind of feels like nothing has changed.”

Feminist author Soraya Chemaly, whose 2018 book “Rage Becomes Her” chronicled the power of female anger, said American women have watched their rights

CORNELL, Page A5

Heating oil prices go through the roof

\$2 a gallon higher than last year; consumers brace

By Karyna Cheung
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The heating oil trucks rumbling up to homes around New England these days are delivering more than fuel for the coming cold weather: a widening sense of dread, as the global energy shock caused by the Iran war pushes prices above \$6 a gallon.

In many places, prices are more than \$2 a gallon higher than last year, presenting some customers with the prospect of paying \$1,500 or more for a full tank.

And given how prices have jumped on so many other essentials, many heating oil customers say their household budgets are at a breaking point.

“Now you’re going to double my heating oil bill? This is just a slap in the face,” said Lisa Furman, who owns a home in Hancock County in northern Maine. “There’s no reason for this.”

She expects to pay \$3,400 for heating oil over the next 10 months, significantly more than the \$1,500 she’s used to spending on heating in a season.

A community therapist, Furman makes too much to qualify for federal heating assistance, so she’s cutting back on any expenses she can spare, and putting more purchases on her credit card.

“It’s this really weird, middle class place that I fall into,” Furman said.

In Massachusetts, the high energy costs prompted Governor Maura Healey to declare a

HEATING OIL, Page A6



Above and below, children read together and played on computers at the Edgerley Family South Boston Club.

MASS. IN THE MIDDLE ON ‘STUDENT SCHOLARSHIPS’

Foes fear they’d take money from public schools, while backers say they would help all

By James Vaznis
GLOBE STAFF

A heated debate is intensifying over whether Massachusetts should join President Trump’s effort to expand school choice by creating “student scholarships” with taxpayer donations.

Teachers unions and other critics, who launched a new coalition against the measure Monday, are deriding the scholarships as a veiled attempt to bring school vouchers to Massachusetts. They say losing students could worsen financial hardships for districts, which rely heavily on per-



student aid.

“This is just another voucher scheme that is really about privatizing public education and will be extremely harmful to our students,” said Jessica Tang, president of the American Federation of Teachers Massachusetts, a union that represents educators in Boston, Lawrence, Lowell, and elsewhere.

But many philanthropic organizations and other supporters, who also have their own coalition, say the scholarships could be a boon for public school families, helping them pay

STUDENTS, Page A10

R.I. town fed up with Amazon warehouse

Johnston officials note use of rescues, fire safety issues

By Amanda Milkovits and Edward Fitzpatrick
GLOBE STAFF

JOHNSTON, R.I. — More than a year after its grand opening, a massive Amazon warehouse in Rhode Island has failed to follow basic fire safety practices, used town rescue trucks as a “medical Uber,” and brushed off requests for additional fire-fighting equipment, Mayor Joseph M. Polisena and Fire Chief Keith A. Calci told the Globe in an interview.

During the July 2025 ribbon-cutting ceremony for Amazon’s \$400 million robotics fulfillment center, Polisena declared it “a proud day for Johnston.” The 3.8-million-square-foot, five-story building, which stretches nearly a quarter-mile on a hill with a view of the Providence skyline, promised to bring more than 1,500 jobs to this town of about 30,000 residents.

There have been complaints about poor working conditions, high volumes of rescue calls, and safety issues at other Amazon warehouses around the country, including in New England, where about 30 fulfillment and sorting distribution cen-

AMAZON, Page A7

Info-overloaded parents dream of going old school

BETH TEITELL

Where did Janelle Bruno see that notification from the school? Was it on ParentSquare? In an email from the teacher, the district, the superintendent? Was it a text? Does she need to do something? Create an account, download an app, log on to a platform, monitor a portal, enter a code, add lunch funds, or . . . oh, God, the password. What was it?

Please don’t let it be pajama day. Wasn’t that next week???

“I’m losing control,” said Bruno, a mother of three in Charlestown and a photographer who runs her own business, Janelle Carmela Photography.

Oh, we haven’t even talked about the sports apps yet. TeamSnap,

GameChanger, Crossbar, Swimmingly, SwimminglyFan, and maybe one more, but she can’t remember.

Bruno’s two sons are playing town soccer and club soccer. That’s four teams, and on TeamSnap, one boy is identified as “b56-4” and the other is “b56-1.” “I don’t even know who’s who,” Bruno said.

The technical term for what’s going on is the “platformization of education.” Technology in the classroom existed way before the pandemic, but remote learning supercharged the category. And now the learning management systems, family engagement platforms, assessment, testing, and security tools, fee-management solutions, and who knows what else have escaped containment.

PLATFORMS, Page A10

The Trump administration is likely to continue its attempts to ban all international students from enrolling at Harvard University, lawyers told federal judges. B1.

Eva Marie Saint died at 102. She won an Oscar for her first movie, “On the Waterfront,” and starred opposite Cary Grant in the Alfred Hitchcock thriller “North by Northwest.” **C8.**

Cambridge tech firm HubSpot is laying off nearly 660 employees, about 7 percent of its workforce. B7.

Jury selection began in the trial of Matthew Farwell, accused of killing Sandra Birchmore. B1.

The ride-share giant Uber is acquiring Boston-based ezCater, one of the top office catering companies in the country, for \$2.3 billion. B7.

Suddenly, lasting summer

Wednesday: Sunny and warming up. High 65-70. Low 54-59.

Thursday: Heating up even more. High 72-77. Low 51-56.

Weather and Comics, G8-9.

Pizzas that deliver the goods

After eating far and wide, we’ve whittled it down to 12 — each one a compelling reason to break out of your pizza routine, writes Devra First. **G1.** Also check out the pizza lover’s style guide. **G4.**

